

Sixty Voices

Every option in Block 5 now carries two short stories. One is read by participants who keep their choice; the other by participants who drop it. This sheet shows all sixty, next to the line each one must not repeat.

WHAT THE PARTICIPANT READS FIRST

- Low** — Someone you have known for twenty years, and care about very much...
- Medium** — Someone you have known for about a year, and might care about...
- High** — Someone you have only just met...

That opening line is chosen by the participant’s stakeholder sensitivity, and it is the same for all thirty options. The stories below are everything that comes *after* it, which is why they all begin with **They**.

Rule 1 Both sides exist No option may fall back to a generic line. 30 / 30	Rule 2 Not a repeat A story may not restate the option’s own “you give up” line. worst 23%, limit 34%	Rule 3 The same person No story introduces a stranger. It describes whoever the opening line named. 0 strangers	Rule 4 Reads after “They” The sentence must be grammatical once the template adds its subject. 60 / 60
Rule 5 Neither side pushes harder Hurt and needed-it are matched in length, so the measure is not steered. 142 vs 142 chars			

Getting to Fairhaven

`travel_rural_lifeline_bus` Take the slow bus that stops in every town

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
Eight extra hours and most of your energy. You reach Fairhaven late and exhausted.

HURTS 140	NEEDED IT 166
<i>They</i> took a day off work without pay to be free the evening you arrive. You get there eight hours late, and the day they paid for is spent waiting.	<i>They</i> live on that route and have no car; the hospital they attend is forty miles up the line. Every seat sold is what keeps the service running until their next appointment.

`travel_express_coach` Take the direct express bus

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
The small towns. Every passenger the express carries is income the local service never receives.

HURTS 148	NEEDED IT 146
<i>They</i> have no car, and live in one of the towns the express drives past. When that route closes next year, they lose the only way out of the town they have.	<i>They</i> make this same journey twice a month on a low wage. The express is the only fare they can afford, and it stays that cheap only while the seats fill.

`travel_intercity_train` Take the overnight train

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
Money and flexibility. The ticket is well above the bus, and you still need local transport at both ends.

HURTS 155	NEEDED IT 131
<i>They</i> had already booked and paid for two tickets for the Saturday. The fare has taken what the rest of the weekend was going to cost, and those tickets go unused.	<i>They</i> work the night crew on that line. The route is under review this year, and ticket numbers are what decide whether their job survives.

travel_direct_flight Take the direct flight

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Clean air and quiet for the people living below. This option pollutes far more than any other on the list.

HURTS

176

They live under the approach path, and their child has been woken by the evening arrivals all year. **The child has started falling asleep in class, and the school has begun to ask why.**

NEEDED IT

139

They are only free on the Thursday, and go into hospital on the Friday. **Flying is the one option that gets you there while they are still at home.**

travel_solo_ev_rental Rent an electric car and drive alone

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Time and money. Recharging adds roughly three hours across the trip, and this is the most expensive option per person.

HURTS

182

They were making the same journey the same week, and asked whether you had a spare seat. **Driving alone leaves that seat empty; they could not afford a fare of their own, and did not travel.**

NEEDED IT

129

They may need you back at short notice while you are away. **Driving yourself is the only option that lets you leave the moment they call.**

travel_shared_car_ride Share a car with three other people

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Your privacy and your independence. You cannot choose when to leave, and you spend around twenty hours in a small car with three strangers, in conversation you may not want.

HURTS

137

They are unwell, and may need you home earlier than you planned. **The car leaves when the driver leaves, and you would not be able to go to them.**

NEEDED IT

152

They are one of the three others in that car, and cannot make this trip any other way. **The ride only runs if the fourth seat is taken, and yours is the fourth.**

Dinner for Four

meal_fair_wage_kitchen

Order from a kitchen that pays its staff properly

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Quantity. Smaller portions, no dessert, and a forty-minute wait for the order.

HURTS147 <i>They</i> came straight from a shift and had not eaten since the morning. The smaller portions run out before they are full, and they are too polite to say so.	NEEDED IT181 <i>They</i> work in a kitchen that pays its people the same way, and the orders have thinned all year. Every table that picks the cheaper kitchen instead is a shift their manager does not roster.
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meal_bulk_home_pot

Cook a large pot of simple food

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Two hours of your evening, and any sense of occasion. It fills people up and little more.

HURTS134 <i>They</i> had been waiting weeks to talk to you about something difficult. You spend the evening at the stove, and the conversation never happens.	NEEDED IT138 <i>They</i> are between jobs, and have been eating one proper meal a day. The leftovers from that pot would have carried them through the next two days.
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meal_seasonal_plant_menu

Cook a seasonal plant-based menu

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Time, skill, and everyone's approval. Two guests will eat politely while wishing you had served something else.

HURTS143 <i>They</i> had been looking forward to this evening for a month, and eat almost none of it. They go home hungry, say nothing about it, and do not ask again.	NEEDED IT150 <i>They</i> cannot eat most of what the other options would have put on the table. This is the one menu where they would not have had to sit and explain themselves.
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meal_delivery_feast Order a large delivery everyone enjoys

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The people at the far end of the order. Low pay for the driver, packaging waste, and the least transparent supply chain here.

HURTS

135

They deliver for that same app in the evenings. **The minutes spent waiting at the door are unpaid, and one slow drop costs them the next order.**

NEEDED IT

157

They are the one who would otherwise have been in the kitchen all evening. **Ordering in is the only version of tonight where they get to sit down with everyone else.**

meal_half_and_half Cook half and buy half

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Any real commitment. It sidesteps every worst case and improves nothing.

HURTS

165

They had told you they were trying to change how they shop, and were watching what you did. **You split the difference, and they quietly decide it cannot be worth the effort.**

NEEDED IT

162

They find these evenings hard, and had been dreading a meal that made a point of itself. **The middle option is the one where nobody has to have an opinion about the food.**

meal_pantry_rescue Cook from your cupboard and rescued surplus

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Control and predictability. Mismatched ingredients, several close to spoiling, and no guarantee every guest finds something they will eat.

HURTS

135

They have a condition that makes an unplanned meal genuinely risky. **They spend the evening checking what is in each dish instead of eating it.**

NEEDED IT

133

They work at the shop that would have put that box in the bin at closing. **They have watched good food go the same way every night this week.**

Limited Cancer Treatment Allocation

cancer_max_total_lives Maximize total lives saved

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
The worst-off. Patients with low survival odds and late diagnoses receive nothing.

HURTS 167	NEEDED IT 145
<i>They</i> were diagnosed late, because the first two appointments were cancelled. The delay is what made those odds low, and the rule reads low odds as a reason to pass them over.	<i>They</i> have exactly the odds this rule looks for, and a cancer caught early. Any rule that ignores odds is one where their good chance counts for nothing.

cancer_prioritize_vulnerable Protect the most vulnerable first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
Total lives saved. Some doses go to patients who are unlikely to recover.

HURTS 122	NEEDED IT 161
<i>They</i> would have recovered fully, and sit just outside the sickest group. They wait another month, and by then they are inside it.	<i>They</i> are the kind of patient this rule protects, and have been passed over twice already. Every other rule here reads their condition as a reason to treat someone else.

cancer_max_life_years Maximize life-years (treat the best responders)

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS
Older patients. A life with fewer years left is counted as worth less.

HURTS 135	NEEDED IT 134
<i>They</i> are seventy-one, and are raising a grandchild on their own. The rule counts the years they have left, and never asks who depends on them.	<i>They</i> are twenty-six, and were told this treatment would give them decades. This is the only rule that counts those decades as worth anything.

cancer_weighted_lottery

Equal-chance lottery (small boost for vulnerable)

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Results. Chance decides, so doses can be used where they do very little good.

HURTS

140

They drew a place, and are already too weak for the treatment to do much. **The dose is used, and the person behind them is told there are none left.**

NEEDED IT

117

They have been ranked last by every rule the hospital has tried. **The draw is the only one that ever gave them a real chance.**

cancer_reserve_underserved

Reserve a share for hard-to-reach / underserved patients

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Reach and certainty. Fewer patients are treated, and reserved doses may go unused.

HURTS

137

They were next on the list on the day the reserve was set aside. **The dose held back for someone who never came is the one they were waiting for.**

NEEDED IT

153

They live four hours from the hospital, and have never once been on a list in time. **The reserve is the only reason a dose would still be there when they arrive.**

cancer_essential_workers

Prioritize essential workers / caregivers

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The sickest patients, and the idea that every life counts the same.

HURTS

145

They are sicker than anyone else on the list, and retired eight years ago. **Nobody depends on them any more, and the rule reads that as a reason to wait.**

NEEDED IT

142

They are one of only two people who can keep the dialysis unit open. **If they are not treated the unit closes, and forty other people lose their week.**

Flood Evacuation Priority

flood_largest_neighborhoods Evacuate the largest neighborhoods first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The worst-off: disabled, elderly, and isolated residents who depend on a bus that may never come.

HURTS 145	NEEDED IT 143
<i>They</i> use a wheelchair, and live on the third floor of a block with no working lift. The buses fill in the streets below, and nobody comes up the stairs.	<i>They</i> live in the largest block on the estate, with two hundred others. Only the plan that goes where the numbers are gets a bus to their door in time.

flood_vulnerable_groups_first Evacuate those who cannot escape on their own first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Total reach and speed: many who could have been saved wait as resources go to a difficult few.

HURTS 132	NEEDED IT 113
<i>They</i> were waiting at the roadside with two children when the boats were redirected. The water reaches that road before the boats come back.	<i>They</i> cannot leave the house without two people to lift them. Every other plan counts that as too slow to be worth doing.

flood_highest_risk_zones Evacuate the deadliest zones first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Reachable 'safer' areas get nothing; people there are written off because their danger score was lower.

HURTS 139	NEEDED IT 113
<i>They</i> live on a street the model scored as safe, behind a wall nobody checked. The wall gives way at four in the morning, and no one has been sent.	<i>They</i> live where the water comes first and deepest. A plan that spreads itself evenly reaches them long after it matters.

flood_efficient_rescue Send each rescue boat where it saves the most people per trip

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The isolated and far-flung: long flooded lanes and lone houses the math says are not worth the trip.

HURTS

121

They were on the first list, until someone recalculated what each trip was worth. **Nobody tells them they have been taken off it.**

NEEDED IT

126

They are one of nine people waiting at a single pick-up point. **Only a plan that counts people per trip sends a boat for nine at once.**

flood_balanced_mixed_plan Split the fleet across every priority at once

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Decisiveness and total rescues: refusing to prioritize can cost lives a committed plan would have saved.

HURTS

126

They were told help was coming, and stayed in the house because of it. **The boat promised to three places at once reaches theirs last.**

NEEDED IT

137

They live in the one area that every focused plan leaves out. **Spreading the fleet thin is the only reason anything comes to their street at all.**

flood_reserve_capacity Hold back part of the fleet for the predicted second surge

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Certain help for people endangered now, traded for protection against an uncertain worse tomorrow.

HURTS

125

They are on a roof tonight, in the water that is already here. **They can see the boats tied up, held for a surge that may never come.**

NEEDED IT

129

They live where the second surge is forecast to hit hardest. **If everything is spent tonight, there is nothing left when it reaches them.**

Water Contamination Response

water_protect_critical_sites Protect hospitals, dialysis centers, and elder-care first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Total reach: the majority keep drinking unsafe water while resources protect a vulnerable few.

HURTS 139	NEEDED IT 160
<i>They</i> have a six-month-old, and have been boiling every drop for nine days. They run out of gas for the stove before any crew reaches their street.	<i>They</i> have dialysis three times a week at one of the clinics on that list. Unsafe water in that building is not an inconvenience for them, it is a week they do not get.

water_largest_neighborhoods Protect the largest neighborhoods first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The most fragile: hospitals, dialysis, and care homes serving those least able to cope with exposure.

HURTS 135	NEEDED IT 149
<i>They</i> look after their mother at home, on a machine that needs clean water. The large streets are cleared first, and theirs is not a large one.	<i>They</i> live in a block of ninety flats that every other plan reaches last. Going where the numbers are is the only reason clean water arrives there this week.

water_shutoff_highest_contamination Treat the highest-contamination zones first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Reachable lower-risk districts get nothing; people there are written off because their exposure was smaller.

HURTS 127	NEEDED IT 152
<i>They</i> live in a district the readings called clean, beside a pipe nobody sampled. Their whole street drinks it for another eleven days.	<i>They</i> live where the readings are worst, and three people on their landing are already ill. Any plan that spreads itself evenly leaves them drinking it longest.

water_efficient_exposure

Send each crew where it removes the most exposure per hour

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

The isolated and far-flung: small clusters the math judges are not worth a crew's time.

HURTS

155

They live at the end of a lane where one crew-hour serves four houses instead of forty. **The arithmetic is done once, and their lane is never put on a route again.**

NEEDED IT

134

They live in a cluster where one crew can clear forty homes in a morning. **Only a plan that counts crew-hours reaches them before the weekend.**

water_balanced_targeted_response

Citywide boil-water advisory plus thin targeted delivery

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Effectiveness and decisiveness: hedging can protect fewer people than committing to one clear priority.

HURTS

133

They cannot read the advisory, and nobody knocked on the door. **They drink it for a week, believing the warning was meant for somewhere else.**

NEEDED IT

134

They live in the one district that every focused plan writes off. **A thin delivery everywhere is the only reason anything reaches them at all.**

water_restore_system_first

Restore the central treatment system first

THE OPTION ALREADY SAYS

Immediate protection: people in danger today wait while effort goes to the system-wide fix.

HURTS

139

They are seven months pregnant, and were told the repair is three weeks away. **Three weeks is longer than the doctor said the exposure should last.**

NEEDED IT

146

They have been buying bottled water for a month and cannot keep doing it. **Only fixing the plant ends it; everything else is another delivery to wait for.**

Simple English Explanation

What this page is, in plain words.

In Block 5 the participant picks an option. Then one person speaks to them. We want to know whether hearing a real person changes the participant's mind — and **how close that person is to them** changes how loud that voice should feel.

So every option needs **two** stories, because the participant can go two ways:

1. If they say **“yes, I still choose this”**, they meet the person this choice **hurts**. We ask: knowing that, do you still choose it?
2. If they say **“no, not any more”**, they meet the person who **needed** it. We ask: knowing that, do you go back to it?

Both stories have to be fair. If the sad story is strong and the hopeful story is weak, then everybody changes their mind, and we have measured **our own writing** instead of the participant. That is why the five rules above exist, and why a script now checks all sixty every time the project is built.

The one thing a script cannot judge is whether a sentence is **true and worth reading**. That is what this page is for.